INFO – RASHAN (1-Topic-in-1-Page)

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TOPIC 1 | GS-I | Geography – Rivers; Places in News (Mapping)

The Yamuna: From Yamunotri to Prayagraj – and Delhi's First River Cruise

CONTEXT: Delhi's **first Yamuna cruise** opened at **Sonia Vihar** with a **30-seat electric boat**.

1,376 km	6,387 m	<2%	>75%
Length	Source height	Delhi stretch length	Its pollution share

1. Course
- Yamunotri Glacier
- Uttarkashi
- Joins Ganga at Prayagraj

2. Right bank
- Tons (largest)
- Chambal, Sindh
- Betwa, Ken

3. Left bank
- Hindon, Giri
- Rishi Ganga
- Hanuman Ganga

4. Cruise
- Sonia Vihar–Jagatpur
- 30-seat e-boat
- NW-110



Photo: the Yamuna in Delhi, seen from a Metro train crossing the river.

Photo: Kool Nerd 123, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY 4.0

KEY TERMS

Tributary: Joins a bigger river
NW-110: Yamuna waterway
IWAI: Waterways authority

PRELIMS HOOK

Yamuna – from Yamunotri Glacier (Bandarpunch, Uttarkashi); ~1,376 km; Ganga's longest tributary, meets it at Prayagraj; right bank: Tons, Chambal, Sindh, Betwa, Ken; left bank: Hindon, Giri; Delhi cruise on NW-110.

MAINS ANGLE

River pollution, river-front development and inland waterways.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "A clean river is the first condition for river tourism." Discuss with reference to the Yamuna in Delhi. (150 words)

TOPIC 2 | GS-I | Society – Urbanisation; Sanitation

Swachh Survekshan 2025–26: Navi Mumbai Leads, and Cities Now Mentor Each Other

CONTEXT: Swachh Survekshan 2025–26: Navi Mumbai tops; **70 mentor cities** guide **191 mentee cities.**

4,751	2.70 crore	70 + 191	80%
Cities surveyed	Citizen feedback	Mentor + mentee cities	Urban waste processed

1. Survey
- Since 2016
- 10th edition
- 43 indicators

2. Top cities
- Navi Mumbai
- Surat
- Vijayawada

3. City pairs
- Each One, Teach One
- 100-day plan
- SBM-U 2.0 funds

4. New awards
- Himalayan – Rudrapur
- River front – Rewa
- Coastal – Puri

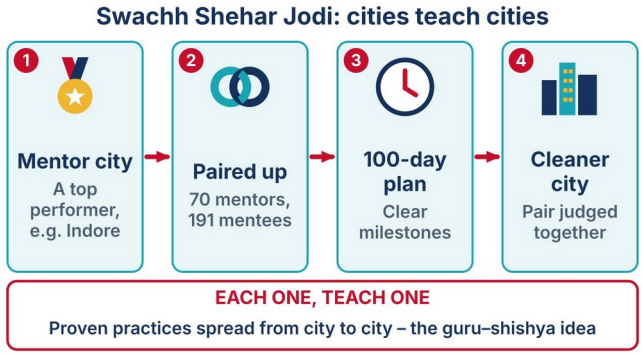


Illustration: how a Swachh Shehar Jodi works – a mentor city guides a mentee city to cleaner streets.

KEY TERMS
ULB: Municipal body
Jodi: Mentor–mentee pair
Legacy waste: Old dump cleared

PRELIMS HOOK
Swachh Survekshan (MoHUA, SBM-U; since 2016); 2025–26 = 10th edition, 4,751 cities; Navi Mumbai tops Super Swachh League; Swachh Shehar Jodi – 70 mentor + 191 mentee cities.

MAINS ANGLE
Urban sanitation, peer learning and capacity of local bodies.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Peer learning between cities can do what funds alone cannot." Examine with reference to the Swachh Shehar Jodi initiative. (150 words)

TOPIC 3 | GS-II | Governance – Public Distribution System; Food Security | UPDATE

One Nation, One Ration Card: Portable Rations, but Few Migrants Use Them Across States

CONTEXT: ONORC runs in **all 36 States/UTs**, but only **0.7%** of transactions are **inter-State**.

36	3.27 crore	0.7%	233 crore+
States/UTs covered	Transactions a month	Inter-State share	Transactions so far

1. What
- Draw ration anywhere
- NFSA card holders
- Aadhaar + e-PoS

2. Reach
- All 36 States/UTs
- 3.27 crore a month
- Mera Ration app

3. Gaps
- 0.7% inter-State
- Fingerprint failures
- Census 2011 lists

4. New tools
- SARTHAK-PDS
- SAKSHAM, NIRMAL
- SMART-PDS

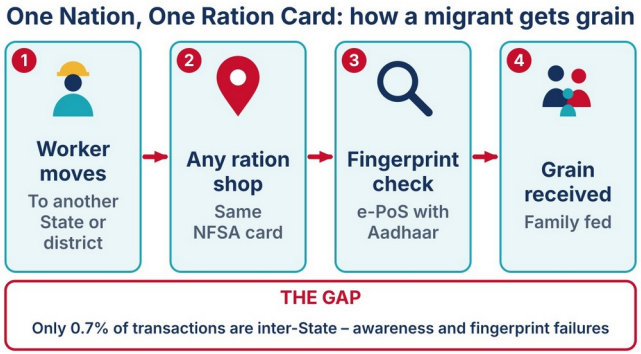


Illustration: how a migrant worker draws subsidised grain from any ration shop – and where the system still breaks.

KEY TERMS
Portability: Ration anywhere
e-PoS: Fingerprint check
FPS: Ration shop

PRELIMS HOOK
ONORC (2019) – portability of NFSA ration cards; all 36 States/UTs; ~3.27 crore transactions a month but only 0.7% inter-State; Mera Ration app (13 languages); SARTHAK-PDS till 31 March 2031.

MAINS ANGLE
Food security of migrants, exclusion errors and technology in the PDS.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Portability has been achieved on paper; it must now reach the migrant." Examine the working of One Nation, One Ration Card. (250 words)

TOPIC 4 | GS-II | Governance / International Relations – Visa Policy

India Trims Its Visa Rulebook: 9 Main Categories, a New 'Visitor Visa'

CONTEXT: The **MHA** cut main visa categories from **13 to 9**; the Tourist Visa is now the **Visitor Visa**.

13 → 9	49 → 23	172	1, 5, 10 years
Main categories	Sub-categories	e-Visa countries	V-2 validity

1. Categories
- 13 → 9 main
- 49 → 23 sub
- MHA nodal

2. Visitor
- Tourist renamed
- V-1: 30 days
- V-2: 1, 5, 10 years

3. Medical
- M-1, M-2
- M-3 AYUSH
- M-4 attendant

4. Student
- S-1 study
- S-2 research
- e-Visa: 172 nations

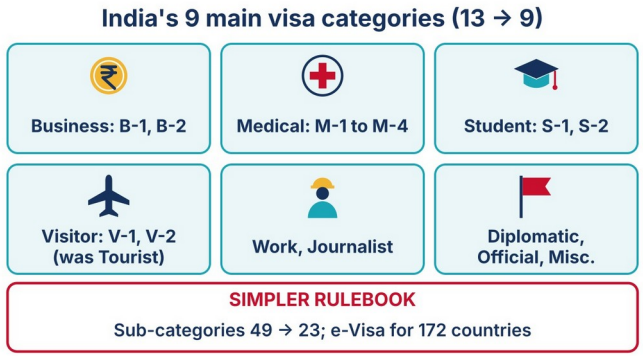


Illustration: the nine main visa categories after the rationalisation, with the new Visitor Visa.

KEY TERMS
V-1: Short visitor visa
M-3: AYUSH treatment
e-Visa: Online permit

PRELIMS HOOK
Visa rationalisation (MHA, 27 Aug 2026): main categories 13 → 9, sub-categories 49 → 23; Tourist Visa renamed Visitor Visa (V-1, V-2); M-3 = AYUSH treatment; e-Visa for 172 countries.

MAINS ANGLE
Soft power, medical tourism and ease of travel.

PRACTICE (MAINS): How can a simpler visa regime support India's goals in medical tourism, education and investment? (150 words)

TOPIC 5 | GS-II | Governance – Schemes for Vulnerable Sections; Financial Inclusion

Stand-Up India Extended to 2031: Bank Loans for Women, SC and ST Entrepreneurs

CONTEXT: Stand-Up India extended to **31 March 2031** with an **85% credit guarantee**.

₹10 lakh–1 crore	85%	₹4,111 crore	2.5 lakh+
Loan size	Credit guarantee	New corpus	More beneficiaries

1. Who
- Women
- SC and ST
- Above 18 years

2. Loan
- ₹10 lakh–₹1 crore
- Up to 85% of cost
- Greenfield only

3. Guarantee
- 85% cover
- ₹4,111 crore fund
- Fee 0.50%

4. Banks
- Every branch
- 1 SC/ST + 1 woman
- Portal support

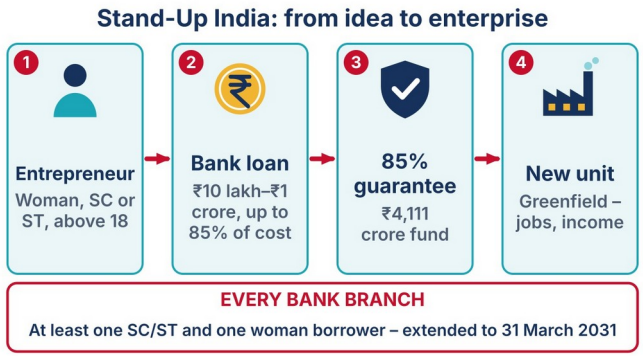


Illustration: how Stand-Up India takes a woman, SC or ST entrepreneur from a bank loan to a new enterprise.

KEY TERMS

Greenfield: Brand-new unit
Guarantee: Fund covers default
Collateral: Pledged asset

PRELIMS HOOK

Stand-Up India (5 Apr 2016; Dept of Financial Services) – greenfield loans ₹10 lakh–₹1 crore for women, SC, ST; extended to 31 March 2031; 85% guarantee; ₹4,111 crore corpus.

MAINS ANGLE

Financial inclusion, entrepreneurship and social justice.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Credit without collateral is the first step; handholding is the second." Discuss with reference to the Stand-Up India Scheme. (150 words)

TOPIC 6 | GS-III | Economy – Infrastructure: Energy | UPDATE

India's 900-GW Clean Power Goal: Cheap Solar Noon, Costly Evenings

CONTEXT: India targets **900 GW non-fossil** by 2035 – but **evening power** and **storage** lag.

900 GW	54.2%	~40 GW	$22.7 tn
Non-fossil goal, 2035	Non-fossil capacity share	Solar without buyers	Investment to 2070

1. Status
- 54.2% non-fossil
- ~¼ of generation
- 200 GW+ modules

2. Problem
- Cheap noon power
- Costly evenings
- 40 GW unsold

3. Chance
- $22.7 tn to 2070
- 15% cost saving
- 200 GW storage

4. Fixes
- Neutral auctions
- Time-of-day tariffs
- Home-made batteries

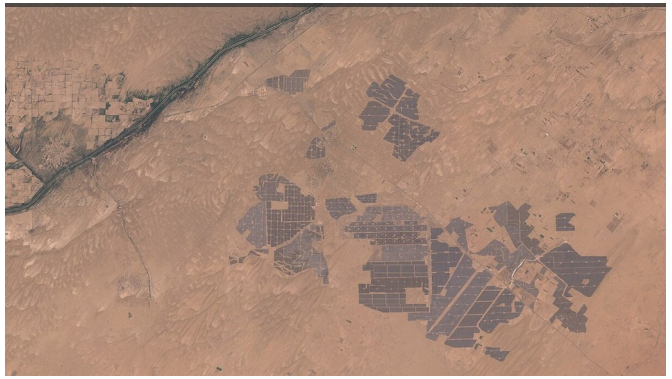


Photo: a satellite view of Bhadla Solar Park in Rajasthan – rows of solar panels across the desert.
Photo: Copernicus Sentinel-2, ESA, Wikimedia Commons, Attribution

KEY TERMS
Non-fossil: No coal, oil, gas
DISCOM: Power retailer
Thermal-mimic: RE + storage on call

PRELIMS HOOK
Clean power: 900 GW non-fossil by 2035; net zero 2070; non-fossil 54.2% of capacity (June 2026); COP26 50% target met in 2025; SECI thermal-mimic ₹5.25–5.26/unit; ~200 GW storage needed.

MAINS ANGLE
Energy security, grid flexibility and the economics of the transition.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "India's clean power challenge has moved from building capacity to delivering power when it is needed." Discuss. (250 words)

TOPIC 7 | GS-III | Economy / Science & Technology – Critical Minerals; Circular Economy

Black Mass Export Banned: Turning Dead Batteries into Critical Minerals

CONTEXT: The **DGFT** has **banned black mass exports** to keep battery minerals at home.

40–50%	10–20%	>90%	₹1,500 cr
Of EV battery weight	Informal recovery	Formal recovery	Recycling incentive

1. What
- Shredded battery powder
- Li, Co, Ni, Mn
- Plus graphite

2. Ban
- DGFT order
- Free → Prohibited
- Feedstock at home

3. Gaps
- Informal scrap
- 10–20% recovery
- Weak collection

4. Support
- BWMR 2022 (EPR)
- NCMM
- ₹1,500 cr scheme

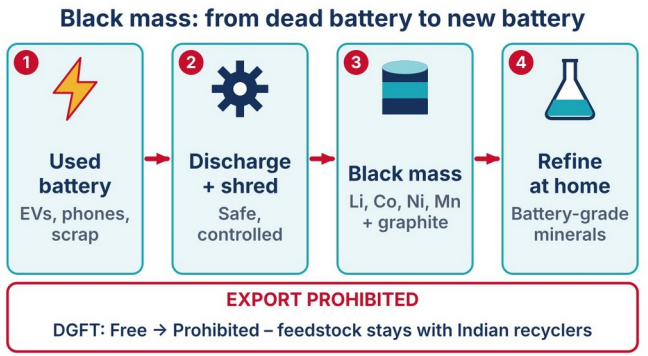


Illustration: how a used battery becomes black mass and then battery-grade minerals at home.

KEY TERMS
Black mass: Battery powder
EPR: Producer must recycle
Urban mining: Metals from waste

PRELIMS HOOK
Black mass = shredded Li-ion battery powder (Li, Co, Ni, Mn + graphite); ~40–50% of EV battery weight; DGFT: export Free → Prohibited; Battery Waste Management Rules 2022 (EPR); ₹1,500 cr scheme (Sept 2025).

MAINS ANGLE
Critical mineral security, urban mining and the circular economy.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Waste batteries are India's newest mine." Examine how battery recycling can strengthen critical mineral security. (250 words)

TOPIC 8 | GS-III | Economy – Taxation; Resource Mobilisation | UPDATE

Fewer Exemptions, Wider Base: The Next Round of Tax Reform

CONTEXT: Experts call for **fewer exemptions** and a **wider tax base** to lift investment.

148	₹150 lakh	Sept 2025	1 Nov 2026
Goods outside GST	Composition limit	GST rationalisation	Admin reforms

1. Need
- Wider base
- Lower deficit
- More investment

2. Distortions
- Exemptions
- Cascading taxes
- Unequal treatment

3. Recent
- GST rationalised
- Simpler admin
- Capital gains review

4. Next
- Cut exemptions
- Full input credit
- Tax neutrality



Illustration: what distorts India's tax system today and the fixes that can lift investment.

KEY TERMS
Cascading: Tax on tax
ITC: Input tax set-off
Neutrality: No tilt in choices

PRELIMS HOOK
Tax reform: 148 goods (4-digit HSN) outside GST; petroleum outside GST → cascading; composition scheme (turnover < ₹150 lakh) – no input tax credit; GST rationalised Sept 2025; admin reforms from 1 Nov 2026.

MAINS ANGLE
Resource mobilisation, tax neutrality and investment.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "The aim of tax reform should be a broader base, not higher rates." Discuss the distortions in India's tax system and suggest remedies. (250 words)

TOPIC 9 | GS-III | Economy – Financial Inclusion; MSMEs

Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units Extended to 2031 – With Lower Fees

CONTEXT: CGFMU extended to **March 2031**; guarantee fee for Mudra loans cut to **0.75%**.

₹5,000 cr	0.75%	₹20 lakh	₹12.6 lakh cr
New corpus	Fee for Mudra loans	Mudra loan cover	Credit expected

1. Fund
- Since Jan 2016
- NCGTC manages
- Finance Ministry

2. Covers
- Mudra ≤ ₹20 lakh
- Jan Dhan OD ₹10,000
- SHG loans

3. New
- Fee 1% → 0.75%
- ₹5,000 cr corpus
- Till March 2031

4. Gain
- No collateral
- Fewer moneylenders
- More jobs

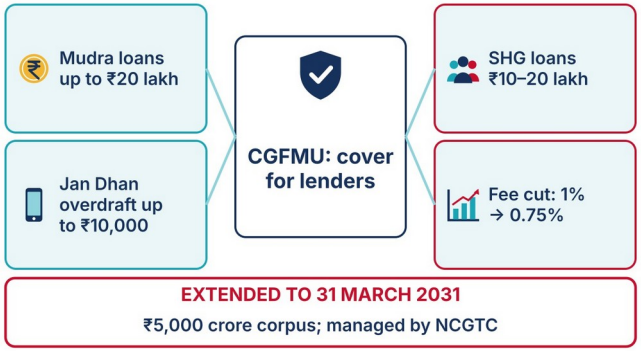


Illustration: how CGFMU covers banks so micro-entrepreneurs get loans without collateral.

KEY TERMS
NCGTC: Guarantee manager
PMMY: Mudra loans
MLI: Covered lender

PRELIMS HOOK
CGFMU (Jan 2016; NCGTC, Ministry of Finance) – guarantees collateral-free Mudra loans up to ₹20 lakh, Jan Dhan overdrafts up to ₹10,000, SHG loans; extended to 31 March 2031; fee 1% → 0.75%; ₹5,000 cr corpus.

MAINS ANGLE
Financial inclusion, MSME credit and risk sharing.

PRACTICE (MAINS): How do credit guarantee schemes widen access to formal credit? Discuss their risks too. (150 words)

TOPIC 10 | GS-III | Agriculture – Farm Subsidies; Fertilisers

Nutrient Based Subsidy for Rabi 2026–27: ₹62,370 Crore for P&K Fertilisers

CONTEXT: NBS for Rabi 2026–27: ₹62,370 crore for **P&K fertilisers**.

₹62,370 cr	+₹24,418 cr	28	2010
Rabi 2026–27 outlay	Over last Rabi	P&K grades	NBS began

1. Scheme
- Dept of Fertilizers
- Since April 2010
- P&K only

2. Nutrients
- N, P, K, S
- Boron, zinc extra
- Urea excluded

3. Payment
- Per-kg rate
- After PoS sale
- Aadhaar check

4. Goal
- Balanced use
- Soil health
- Price shield

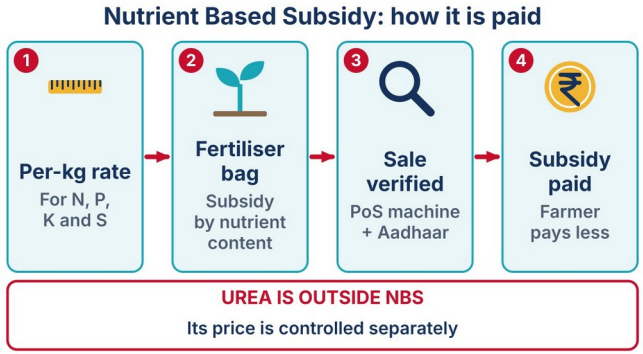


Illustration: how the NBS subsidy is worked out from each nutrient in a fertiliser bag and paid after a verified sale.

KEY TERMS

NBS: Per-nutrient subsidy
DAP: Phosphate fertiliser
MOP: Potash fertiliser

PRELIMS HOOK

NBS (since 1 April 2010; Dept of Fertilizers) – fixed per-kg subsidy on N, P, K, S in P&K fertilisers; urea excluded; 28 grades including DAP, MOP, SSP; Rabi 2026–27 outlay ₹62,370.02 crore.

MAINS ANGLE

Farm subsidies, soil health and fiscal cost.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Keeping urea outside the NBS regime undermines balanced fertilisation." Examine. (150 words)

TOPIC 11 | GS-III | Environment – Climate Change; Reports and Indices

Climate Change Performance Index 2027: India Slips to 28th

CONTEXT: India slipped **five places to 28th** in the **CCPI 2027**.

28th	60.85	40%	1–3
India's rank	India's score	Weight of GHG emissions	Ranks left vacant

1. Index
- Since 2005
- Germanwatch + 2
- 14 indicators

2. Weights
- GHG 40%
- RE, energy use 20% each
- Policy 20%

3. Top/bottom
- 4th Denmark
- 7th UK (G20)
- 68th Iran

4. India
- 28th (Medium)
- Down from 23rd
- RE rated High

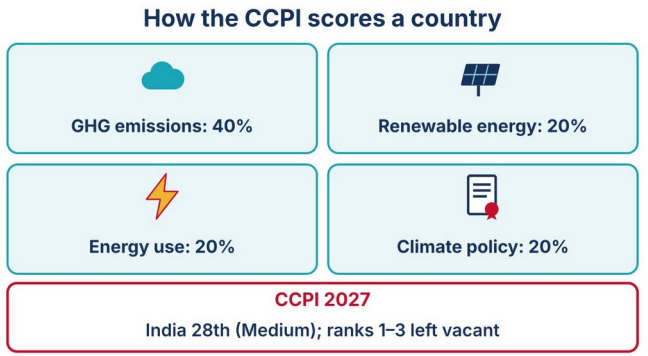


Illustration: how the CCPI scores countries – four categories and their weights.

KEY TERMS
CCPI: Climate action rank
Curtailment: Wasted RE output
1.5°C path: Paris-aligned

PRELIMS HOOK
CCPI 2027 (Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute, CAN International; since 2005): India 28th (score 60.85, Medium), down from 23rd; ranks 1–3 vacant; Denmark 4th; UK 7th – only G20 'High'; Iran last (68th).

MAINS ANGLE
Climate commitments, implementation gaps and global assessments.

PRACTICE (MAINS): India adds clean capacity fast but slips in climate rankings. Explain the gap and suggest remedies. (150 words)

TOPIC 12 | GS-III | Infrastructure – Railways; Disaster Management

Sairang Express Derails in Assam: Why Rail Safety Must Be Preventive

CONTEXT: The **Kolkata–Sairang Express derailed** in **Assam**; no deaths reported.

~75%	154	63%	19
Derailments' share (CAG)	Human-error derailments	Inquiries delayed	Railway zones

1. Incident
- Digaru, Kamrup
- Loop-line entry
- No deaths

2. Causes
- Track defects
- Over-speeding, SPAD
- Signal errors

3. Done
- Kavach
- RRSK fund
- LHB coaches

4. Next
- Kavach everywhere
- Crew-hour caps
- Fast CRS reports

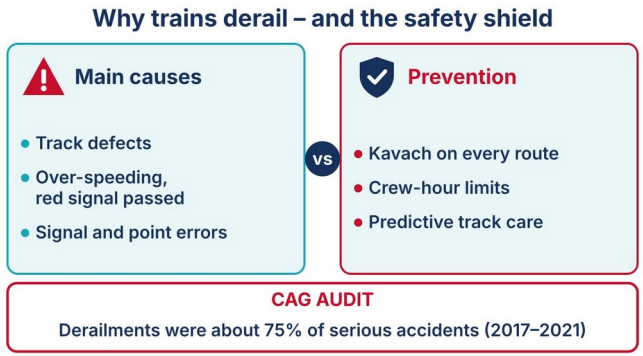


Illustration: the main causes of derailments and the safety shield that can prevent them.

KEY TERMS
SPAD: Red signal passed
Kavach: Auto train protection
RRSK: Safety fund

PRELIMS HOOK
Sairang Express (Kolkata–Sairang, Mizoram) derailed near Digaru, Kamrup (Assam), NFR zone; CAG 2022: derailments ~75% of serious accidents (2017–21); Kavach = indigenous ATP; RRSK = non-lapsable safety fund.

MAINS ANGLE
Railway safety, accountability and preventive technology.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Rail safety must move from post-accident inquiries to prevention." Discuss with reference to recent derailments. (250 words)

TOPIC 13 | GS-III | Internal Security – Terrorism in J&K

Kulgam Checkpoint Attack: The Challenge of Hit-and-Run Militancy

CONTEXT: Three CRPF men were hurt in a **hit-and-run attack** on a **Kulgam** checkpoint.

3	~30	15 s	46 Bn
CRPF men injured	Rounds fired	Duration	CRPF unit

1. Attack
- Kulgam checkpoint
- Motorcycle-borne
- Hit and run

2. Drivers
- Cross-border help
- Hybrid militants
- Forest cover

3. Response
- MAC intelligence
- CIBMS
- VDGs, UAPA

4. Next
- Harden posts
- HUMINT
- Counter-drone

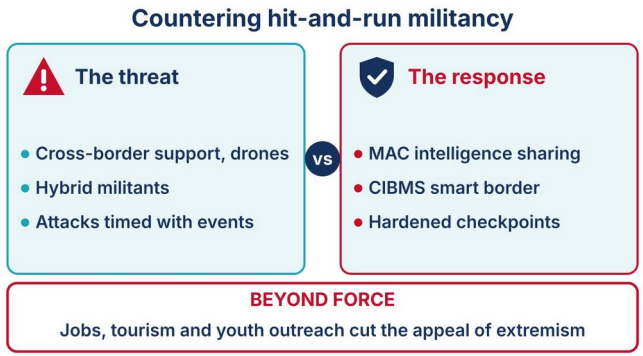


Illustration: how hybrid militants strike and the layers of response that can stop them.

KEY TERMS
OGW: Militants' helper
MAC: Intelligence hub
CIBMS: Smart border

PRELIMS HOOK
Kulgam (J&K): motorcycle-borne terrorists fired on a CRPF checkpoint (46 Bn), 3 injured; hybrid militancy; MAC = intelligence sharing; CIBMS = smart border fencing; VDGs = armed village volunteers.

MAINS ANGLE
Cross-border terrorism, hybrid militancy and counter-terror strategy.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "Large militant networks are weaker, but hybrid militancy remains a threat." Discuss the strategy needed in Jammu and Kashmir. (250 words)

TOPIC 14 | GS-III | Security – Coastal Security; Defence Exercises

Sea Vigil-26: India Tests Its Whole Coastline Against Threats from the Sea

CONTEXT: The Navy-led **Sea Vigil-26** tests **coastal defence** from **11 to 19 November**.

5th	11–19 Nov	7,516+ km	2019
Edition	Dates	Coastline	First held

1. About
- Pan-India
- Navy leads
- After 26/11

2. Phases
- CDSRE 11–17 Nov
- Sea phase 18–19 Nov
- Precursor to TROPEX

3. Agencies
- Navy, Coast Guard
- Marine police, CISF
- Fishermen

4. Tests
- Infiltration
- Hijacking
- Port sabotage



Illustration: the two phases of Sea Vigil-26 and the agencies that take part.

KEY TERMS
EEZ: 200 nm resource zone
TROPEX: Navy readiness drill
SLOC: Sea trade routes

PRELIMS HOOK
Sea Vigil-26 (5th edition, 11–19 Nov 2026): pan-India coastal defence exercise led by the Indian Navy; first held Jan 2019 (after 26/11 lessons); CDSRE + Sea Phase; precursor to TROPEX.

MAINS ANGLE
Coastal security, inter-agency coordination and maritime domain awareness.

PRACTICE (MAINS): How has India's coastal security architecture evolved since 26/11? Assess the role of exercises like Sea Vigil. (150 words)

TOPIC 15 | GS-III | Security / International Relations – Defence Exercises

IMNEX-26: India and Myanmar Navies Exercise at Visakhapatnam

CONTEXT: IMNEX-26, the **8th** India–Myanmar naval exercise, is on at **Visakhapatnam**.

8th	2018	10–14 Nov	Vizag
Edition	First held	Dates	Venue

1. About
- India–Myanmar
- Bilateral
- Since 2018

2. 2026
- 8th edition
- Visakhapatnam
- India hosts

3. Phases
- Harbour
- Sea
- Interoperability

4. Ties
- IMBAX (army)
- Act East
- Bay of Bengal

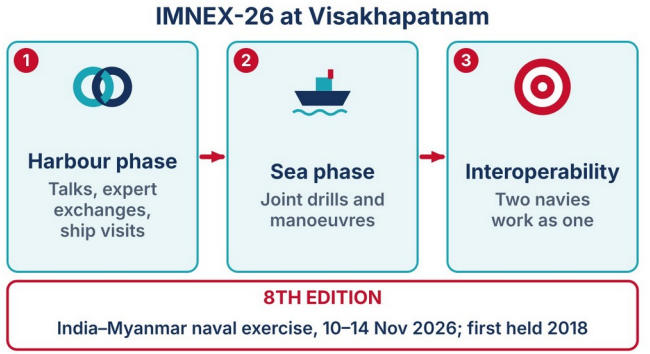


Illustration: the harbour and sea phases of IMNEX-26 and what each builds.

KEY TERMS
IMNEX: India–Myanmar navies
IMBAX: India–Myanmar armies
SMEE: Expert exchange

PRELIMS HOOK
IMNEX-26 – 8th India–Myanmar Naval Exercise; Visakhapatnam, 10–14 Nov 2026; India hosts; first held 2018; harbour + sea phases; army exercise with Myanmar = IMBAX.

MAINS ANGLE
India–Myanmar relations, Act East and maritime cooperation.

PRACTICE (MAINS): Discuss the strategic importance of Myanmar for India's Act East Policy and security of the North-East. (150 words)

TOPIC 16 | GS-IV | Ethics – Leadership, Institutions and Accountability

Ethics Synthesis: When a Leader Becomes Indispensable, the Institution Becomes Fragile

CONTEXT: 'Key-man risk' shows why institutions must **outgrow any one leader**.

1	4	3	0
Person – the single point of failure	Core values	Safeguards	Leaders above scrutiny

1. Risk
- One-person dependence
- Weak checks
- No successor

2. Values
- Accountability
- Humility
- Integrity

3. Safeguards
- Independent board
- Audits
- Succession plan

4. Lesson
- Rules over rulers
- Build systems
- Lead to serve



Illustration: the key-man risk – and the institutional safeguards that make an organisation outlast any one leader.

KEY TERMS

Key-man risk: One-person dependence
Succession: Next leaders ready
Stewardship: Hold in trust

PRELIMS HOOK

Key-man risk = over-dependence on one leader; safeguards – succession planning, independent boards, audits; values – accountability, humility, integrity, stewardship.

MAINS ANGLE

Ethical leadership, institutional resilience and accountability.

PRACTICE (MAINS): "The real test of a leader is whether the institution flourishes after the leader leaves." Discuss. (150 words)



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